

Derik Schneider

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Front-End Engineer and Product Designer | US Patent 10,002,393

SUMMARY

Front-end engineer and product designer with 25 years building for the web, including four years writing production React and Redux and a decade architecting UI and design systems, from shipped game interfaces to enterprise component libraries. Deep strengths in component architecture, WCAG accessibility, responsive design, and pixel-perfect implementation in direct partnership with design and marketing stakeholders. Currently rebuilding my personal stack on Next.js (App Router), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, and Contentful, deployed through a CI/CD pipeline. I close the gap between design intent and shipped code.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front-end: React, Redux, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, responsive and mobile-first design, component architecture, Lua (UI scripting)

Actively ramping: Next.js (App Router, SSG/SSR), TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Contentful, CI/CD deployment workflows

Design systems: Figma (auto layout, component libraries), design tokens, grids, SVG systems, Sketch-to-Figma migration, ZeroHeight

Quality and accessibility: WCAG compliance, usability testing, automated test design (101-case suite), cross-environment release validation

Data and APIs: REST API integration (Django backends), Ghost headless CMS API, MySQL, JSON

Tools: Git, Perforce, Jira, A/B and UX research tooling

EXPERIENCE

Principal Product Owner, Action Platform UI - Capital One Apr 2025 - Present

Core agent servicing platform, high-scale account migrations / Remote

- Designed and deployed a 101-case automated testing suite for the platform UI in two months, covering fraud workflows, dynamic timeline suppression, and agent permissions, replacing manual regression cycles and automating compliance reporting.
- Ran end-to-end release validation and production Live Card Testing across lower environments and production deployment windows, verifying authentication, navigation, and feature flags through zero-defect launches.
- Partnered with engineering teams to resolve a critical account key mismatch between two systems, mapping data flows to prevent leakage and converting the fix into permanent automated regression tests.

Lead UX Designer, Action Design Team - Discover Jan 2024 - Mar 2025

Design systems and prototyping for servicing products / Remote

- Migrated the legacy Sketch design system to Figma, building interactive component libraries and integrating the system into front-end development pipelines through design tokens, grids, and SVG standards, cutting page layout time from days to minutes.
- Built high-fidelity interactive prototypes for platform and IVR/Messaging products, including custom 2D/3D assets and animation used by senior leadership to set product direction.

UX/UI Lead - Novant Health (Contract) Jun 2022 - Jul 2023

Aurora Design System / Remote

- Partnered with front-end engineers to implement the Aurora Design System, owning design tokens, grids, SVG standards, responsive behavior, and animation, with WCAG accessibility built into components from the start.

- Rebuilt a previously-ported design system into real Figma components, re-architecting the styles, effects, and foundational elements underneath, so a page could be assembled by drag and drop instead of rebuilt by hand.
- Cut average page layout assembly from days to under an hour, a direct result of the component rebuild rather than a separate process change.
- Served as primary technical liaison to offshore engineering teams adopting the system, reviewing contributions and keeping implementations consistent across products.

UX Designer - Nutrien Ag Solutions Apr 2019 - Jun 2022

Bonsai Design System | Remote

- Co-led the inception and architecture of the Bonsai Design System, then designed and built its documentation website solo, writing the front-end code, responsive layout, and navigation before porting the content into ZeroHeight as the system matured.
- Converted grower and sales-consultant research into a working prototype for a 14-day weather and field workability tool — trafficability status for every field in an operation, two weeks out. It reached 87.5% task success in user studies and went on to ship as a product.

Front End Developer - Agribile, Inc. Mar 2015 - Apr 2019

Production React/Redux development | Urbana-Champaign, IL, then Remote

- Wrote production React and Redux for Agribile's sustainability and field data products for four years, through the company's acquisition by Nutrien, consuming REST APIs from the team's Django backend.
- Built the React admin interface for a community sustainability program adopted by Kellogg's, Anheuser-Busch InBev, and Bayer, translating marketing and partner requirements into shipped features.
- Designed and developed the Weather Story content feature end to end, integrating video and articles through the Ghost headless CMS API, and co-built a React variant generating client-ready seasonal report PDFs.

Lead UX Designer and Developer, State Farm - TEKsystems (Contract) Dec 2012 - Mar 2015

Patented CX research platform | Bloomington, IL

- Designed and drove development of a customer experience insights tool granted US Patent 10,002,393, coordinating systems architecture, MySQL database integration, server management, and security requirements across teams.
- Trained a cohort of designers in HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, enabling in-house interactive prototyping, and built the process for hosting prototypes on internal servers for UX research analysis.

User Interface Artist and Developer - NetherRealm Studios; Volition (THQ) 2007 - 2012

Shipped: Mortal Kombat (2011), Injustice: Gods Among Us, Saints Row 2, Red Faction: Armageddon | Chicago and Champaign, IL

- Designed and personally integrated front-end game UI using custom Lua scripts driving interactions, animation, and real-time game data rendering, including a modular vehicle paint rendering system reused in later Saints Row titles.
- Standardized UI asset output pipelines and trained cross-discipline teams on them, reducing design-to-integration time studio-wide.

Earlier design and development roles 1999 - 2007

UX, web design, and front-end roles for GM/Saturn, Radian Guaranty, Wyeth, and others

- Includes leading a three-designer team building touchscreen kiosk interfaces at GM/Saturn and establishing UX research practices, templates, and UI standards.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

UX Certification, Specialty in Interaction Design - Nielsen Norman Group (2020) | Product Marketing Certificate - eCornell

Art and multimedia studies - Blackhawk College; Minneapolis College of Art and Design